



YOU ARE **34 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**
41 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This profile of the baby shows the tip of the nose touching the placenta. Your placenta will not be growing any more and now thins slightly. Within, the placenta continues to mature and it remains a highly efficient means of supplying your baby's energy needs.

“As your size begins to have an impact on your daily activities, you’ll find that a few practical adjustments are necessary.”

Your posture will change throughout pregnancy as your belly continues to grow. To compensate for the heavy weight you’re carrying, you might find that you lean back slightly, especially when you’re walking downhill. You might also waddle when you walk as you shift your weight from side to side. In a few weeks’ time, when the baby begins to engage into the pelvis (see [When your baby engages](#)), you may find that you waddle even more.

It’s normal at this late stage of pregnancy to move more slowly than normal. You may find yourself struggling to get out of bed or out of a chair, and picking something up off the floor can be more difficult than usual. Tasks such as tying your shoelaces or painting your toenails can seem impossible. You can overcome tasks such as these—for example, by putting your feet on a stool to tie your shoelaces so you don’t have to bend down so far. If you need help, there’s no shame in asking. It can be difficult to be reliant on others, but remember it’s only temporary.

ASK A DOCTOR

Can I have a water birth in the hospital? This depends on the maternity unit: some have birthing pools; others have facilities for you to rent a pool. More hospitals and birthing centers are offering this birthing option, so ask about renting a pool and bringing it in, but realize that just might not be an option.

Most hospitals will support you laboring in a pool or tub, however there are increased risks to your baby with a water birth and is usually not recommended.

A DIABETIC PREGNANCY

Whether you develop diabetes in pregnancy (known as [gestational diabetes](#)), or have preexisting diabetes, you’ll require special care from your doctor. They will figure out a plan for you, since diabetes poses risk in pregnancy.